

CPL, CRT, EXE, HLP, HTA, INF, INS, ISP, JS, JSE, LNK, MDA, MDB, MDE, MDZ, MSC, MSI, MSP, MST, PCD, PIF, PRF, REG, SCF, SCR, SCT, SHB, SHS, URL, VB, VBE, VBS, WSC, WSF and WSH.

If you want Outlook to download any of the above mentioned file extensions, go to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Office\10.0\Outlook\Security** (11.0 for Outlook 2003), and create or modify the string entry named 'Level1Remove'. The value of this entry is the file extension that it will download; so, add the file extensions that you wish Outlook to download, separated by a semicolon—for example, to force Outlook to download EXE and BAT files, assign the value 'exe;bat'.

Add custom places to the open/save dialog box
In the MS Office Open and Save dialog box, there's a

bar on the right that contains links to common locations such as My Computer, My Documents, etc. Using this tweak, you can add custom locations to this bar. For example, if you often save your work on a network drive, you can add it to the places bar. Navigate to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Office\[Version]\Common\OpenFind\Places\UserDefinedPlaces**, where '[Version]' indicates the current office version. Create a sub-key with the name 'PlaceX', where X is a unique number. In other words, name the first custom location 'Place1', the second 'Place2', and so on. Now select the newly created sub-key and create two string entries in it: 'Name' and 'Path'. The value for 'Name', is whatever you want to call that location, and that for 'Path' is the exact path to that folder.

This is because XP tries to get information about the files. To disable this feature, open the registry and go to **HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\CLSID\{87D62D94-71B3-4b9a-9489-5FE6850DC73E}**. Append a [-] (a minus sign) in front of the '{87D...}' key, so that it becomes something like '-{87D...}'.

Prevent OS being paged to disk

At times, when there's a dearth of RAM, the system will move some portion of the main memory to the hard disk. Obviously, this slows down the system, but there's nothing much that can be done about it. In case your system is blessed with loads of RAM (256 MB or more) and runs Windows NT, 2000 or XP, you can use this tweak to prevent the kernel mode code from being moved to the hard disk. While this will improve system performance, it may affect programs that rely on Windows swap space. So if you notice any eccentric behaviour after applying this setting, revert to the previous setting. Go to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\Session Manager\Memory Management**. Look for a DWORD entry called 'DisablePagingExecutive'; set it to '1' to disable the kernel being paged. If you face problems, set it back to '0'.

allows you to increase the USB polling interval. For Windows 98 and Me, go to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\System\CurrentControlSet\Services\Class\Usb\0000**; for Windows 2000 or XP, go to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\System\CurrentControlSet\Control\Class\{36FC9E60-C465-11CF-8056444553540000}\0000**. Create a DWORD entry called 'IdleEnable' and give it a value of '1'. To revert to the previous refresh rate, give the entry a value of '0'.

Quicker access to network folders

When you open a remote location by entering the computer name in the Run dialog box or through Network Neighbourhood, Windows takes a long time to open the location. Instead, when the complete address of the location is given such as '\\computername\folder-name', it opens immediately. Microsoft has confirmed that this occurs when a Windows 2000 system tries to access a Windows 98 system. The system tries to read the scheduled tasks of the remote system—a fairly useless step. To solve the problem, open the registry and delete the **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\RemoteComputer\NameSpace\{D6277990-4C6A-11CF-8D8700AA0060F5BF}** key.

Performance



Disable Windows XP support for Zip files

Windows XP comes with in-built support for Zip files, but this can be a curse in disguise. While searching for files, XP automatically searches through Zip files, resulting in a slow search. To disable support for Zip files, go to **Start > Run**, type '**regsvr32/u%windir%\system32\zipfldr.dll**' and click OK. If you want to enable it

later, go to **Start > Run** and type '**regsvr32 %windir%\system32\zipfldr.dll**'. Disabling support for Zip files in XP does not in any way affect the functionality of third-party tools such as WinZip, WinRAR, etc.

Speed up access to folders with AVI files

Windows XP sometimes takes a really long time to open folders with AVI files.

Increase USB polling interval

By default, Windows checks for connected USB devices once every millisecond. This might prevent the processor from going into power saving mode, which is vital for laptops to conserve battery life. This tweak

